



basalt before rapidly eroding the less resistant tuff beneath. Over thousands of years, this produced numerous tall, thin spires of tuff topped by protective basalt caps.

The Manpupuner Rock Formations

Location The Komi republic, west of the northern Urals, Russia

These seven huge columns of metamorphic crystalline schist stand up like giants from the western slopes of the northern Urals. Their almost-human shapes have inspired a number of legends about their origin. The formations, which range in height from 100 to

138 ft (30 to 42 m), are flat-topped, almost vertical-sided rock towers, or buttes, created by freeze-thaw and wind erosion over many thousands of years.

Other mountains and volcanoes in Europe

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Africa

Pico de Teide

Location Tenerife, the Canary Islands

Measured by its summit elevation above the ocean floor (24,600 ft/7,500 m), this composite volcano on Africa's continental shelf is the highest in the world outside the Hawaiian islands. It rises 12,198 ft (3,718 m) above sea level and is capped by the Las Canadas caldera. Pico de Teide and other vents have erupted several times since the island was settled in 1402, the most recent eruption being in 1909, when lava flows caused some damage.

The Hoggar Mountains

Location Central Sahara Desert, Southern Algeria

This vast lunar landscape in Algeria formed from rocks about 2 billion years old—some of the oldest in Africa. Also known as the Ahaggar Mountains, this range is largely rocky desert, with scant vegetation, at an elevation above 2,950 ft (900 m). Mount Tahat is the highest summit, peaking at 9,541 ft (2,908 m). The bedrock largely comprises ancient metamorphic rocks, although several of the more dramatic peaks result from the erosion of extinct volcanic cones. The droppings of a critically